Supplementary Material

A DERIVATION OF THE EXPONENTIAL BIAS INVERSE CDF

We derive the closed-form inverse CDF for the index-based exponential bias sampler used in Tempest, along with its numerically stable large-n approximation.

A.1 Setup

Consider a temporal neighborhood $\Gamma = \{e_0, e_1, \ldots, e_{n-1}\}$ sorted in increasing timestamp order. The sampling probability for the i-th edge is proportional to e^i:

$$P(i) \propto e^i, \quad i \in \{0, 1, \ldots, n-1\}.$$

A.2 Normalization

The unnormalized weights are:

$$w_i = e^i.$$

The total weight is the finite geometric series:

$$Z = \sum_{k=0}^{n-1} e^k = \frac{e^n - 1}{e - 1}.$$

Thus, the normalized probability is:

$$P(i) = \frac{e^i}{Z} = \frac{(e-1)\, e^i}{e^n - 1}.$$

A.3 CDF

The cumulative distribution function (CDF) up to and including index i is:

$$F(i) = \sum_{k=0}^{i} P(k) = \frac{e^{i+1} - 1}{e^n - 1},$$

using the geometric series sum $\sum_{k=0}^{i} e^k = \frac{e^{i+1}-1}{e-1}$ and cancelling $(e-1)$.

A.4 Inverse Transform Sampling

Inverse transform sampling sets:

$$u = F(i) = \frac{e^{i+1} - 1}{e^n - 1}, \quad u \sim \mathcal{U}(0, 1).$$

Multiplying by $(e^n - 1)$:

$$u(e^n - 1) = e^{i+1} - 1.$$

Adding 1 to both sides:

$$1 + u(e^n - 1) = e^{i+1}.$$

A.5 Solving for i

Taking the natural logarithm:

$$\ln(1 + u(e^n - 1)) = i + 1.$$

Rearranging:

$$i = \ln(1 + u(e^n - 1)) - 1.$$

Since i is an integer index:

$$\boxed{i = \lfloor \ln(1 + u(e^n - 1)) - 1 \rfloor} \tag{1}$$

which matches Equation 5 in the main text.

A.6 Large-n Approximation

When n is large, $e^n \gg 1$ and $e^n - 1 \approx e^n$. The logarithm argument becomes:

$$1 + u(e^n - 1) \approx u\, e^n.$$

Thus:

$$i \approx \ln(u\, e^n) - 1 = \ln(u) + n - 1.$$

This yields the numerically stable approximation:

$$\boxed{i \approx \lfloor n + \ln(u) - 1 \rfloor} \tag{2}$$

matching Equation 6 in the main text.

A.7 Numerical Stability Note

For large n, computing e^n directly may overflow in `float32` (overflow for $n \gtrsim 88$) or `float64` ($n \gtrsim 709$). The form in Equation 2 avoids overflow by separating n additively from $\ln(u)$.

A.8 Worked Example

Let $n = 100$, $u = 0.37$. The exact form (Eq. 1) gives:

$$\begin{aligned} i &= \lfloor \ln(1 + 0.37(e^{100} - 1)) - 1 \rfloor \\ &= \lfloor \ln(1 + 0.37 \times 2.69 \times 10^{43}) - 1 \rfloor \\ &= 98. \end{aligned}$$

Using the large-n form (Eq. 2):

$$i \approx \lfloor 100 + \ln(0.37) - 1 \rfloor = \lfloor 100 - 0.994 - 1 \rfloor = 98.$$

Both forms agree, but the stable form avoids computing $e^{100} = 2.69 \times 10^{43}$ directly.

B DERIVATION OF THE LINEAR BIAS INVERSE CDF

We derive the closed-form inverse CDF for the index-based linear bias sampler.

B.1 Setup

For a temporal neighborhood of length n with indices $i \in \{0, 1, \ldots, n-1\}$, assign linear weights proportional to position:

$$w_i = i + 1.$$

The total weight is:

$$Z = \sum_{k=0}^{n-1} (k + 1) = \frac{n(n+1)}{2}.$$

B.2 Random draw in raw-weight space

Draw a random value r uniformly from $[0, Z)$:

$$r \sim \mathcal{U}([0, Z)).$$

B.3 Solving for i

The index i is found by solving:

$$\frac{i(i+1)}{2} = r \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad i^2 + i - 2r = 0.$$

Applying the quadratic formula and taking the positive root:

$$i = \frac{-1 + \sqrt{1 + 8r}}{2}.$$

Since i must be an integer index, we take the floor:

$$\boxed{i = \left\lfloor \frac{-1 + \sqrt{1 + 8r}}{2} \right\rfloor} \tag{3}$$

B.4 Normalized-u form

If instead we draw $u \sim \mathcal{U}([0, 1))$ and set $r = uZ$ with $Z = \frac{n(n+1)}{2}$, substituting into (3) gives:

$$i = \left\lfloor \frac{-1 + \sqrt{1 + 8u \cdot \frac{n(n+1)}{2}}}{2} \right\rfloor = \left\lfloor \frac{-1 + \sqrt{1 + 4u\, n(n+1)}}{2} \right\rfloor.$$

This is the normalized form used when working with $u \in [0, 1)$.

C DOWNSTREAM TASK: FRAUD DETECTION

In this section, we evaluated Tempest's downstream utility for fraud detection on the DGraph dataset (Table 1 in the main text), a temporal financial interaction graph in which each node has 17-dimensional features and approximately 1.3% of nodes are labeled as fraudsters.

C.0.1 Methodology. We built temporal node embeddings with Tempest random walks and skip-gram Word2Vec: 20 walks per node (10 forward, 10 backward), max walk length 50, and ExponentialIndex edge picker. In streaming mode, edges were processed in batches of 100 timestamps with a sliding window of 400 timestamps. We fused embeddings with tabular features and a small set of node-level graph metrics (log-degree, recency, burstiness, neighbor diversity) via a lightweight MLP. Training used 50 epochs, class-weighted binary cross-entropy, AdamW, cosine learning-rate schedule, and early stopping on validation AUC.

Results. Test ROC-AUC performance (mean ± standard deviation across $n = 5$ independent runs) is reported in Table 1.

Method	ROC–AUC (test)
Ours (fusion MLP)	
Tempest (Streaming) + Node + Graph feats	0.7826 ± 0.0003
Tempest (Full) + Node + Graph feats	0.7844 ± 0.0007
Node + Graph feats	0.7211 ± 0.0006
Tempest (Streaming) + Node feats	0.7252 ± 0.0015
Reported in DGraph [?]	
TGAT (dynamic GNN) [?]	0.792 ± 0.001
SAGE [?]	0.778 ± 0.001
GCN	0.751 ± 0.002
MLPs	0.723 ± 0.002

Table 1: Fraud detection on DGraph

C.0.2 Discussion. Unlike GraphSAGE or TGAT, which are powerful but complex end-to-end GNN pipelines trained offline on full history without incremental updates, our approach centered on Tempest's streaming walk engine that supports sliding-window ingestion and on-the-fly embedding updates. Streaming attained near full-mode accuracy, while the full variant's slightly better performance required keeping the entire graph in memory. Ablations showed that the dominant lift came from Tempest's temporal embeddings, with simple node-level graph metrics being secondary.

D TEMPORAL BIAS FUNCTION VALIDATION

To validate the behavior of different temporal bias functions and their impact on walk structure, we constructed a synthetic temporal graph with 1,000 nodes and 1 million edges where node participation follows a Gaussian distribution centered on the middle nodes (nodes around ID 500). Specifically, we generated edge endpoints by sampling from a normal distribution with mean $\mu = n_nodes/2$ and standard deviation $\sigma = n_{\text{nodes}}/6$, creating higher connectivity for central nodes and lower connectivity for peripheral nodes. We then sampled 1 million walks of maximum length 100 using three edge pickers: `Exponential`, `Linear`, and `Uniform`. Each plot compares the visitation frequency of nodes in the sampled walks with the original edge distribution at the node level.

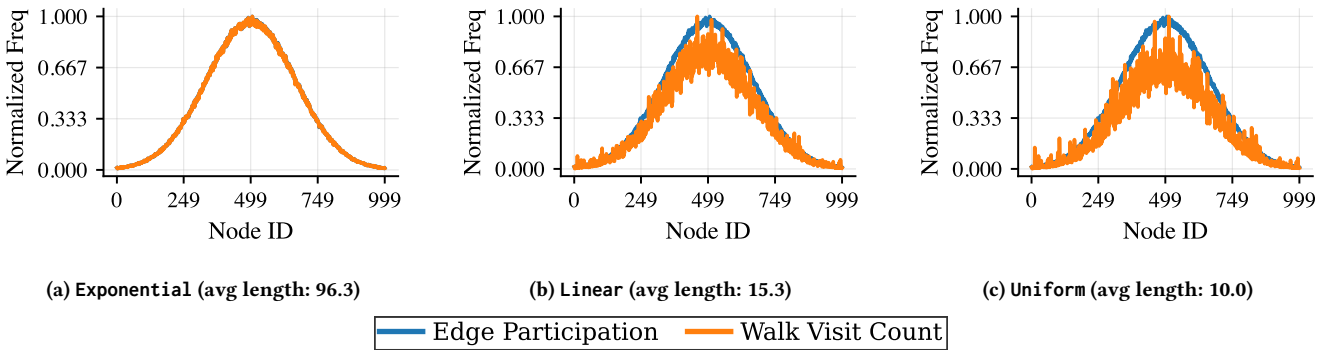
Results. Figure 1 shows that the `Exponential` picker produces walks that most closely match the original distribution. This bias favors edges with timestamps close to the current walk time, which keeps walks concentrated in temporally dense regions—leading to fewer terminations and longer average lengths (96.3 steps). As a result, the visitation frequencies closely align with the original bell-shaped structure. In contrast, `Linear` picker explores more broadly but still with some bias toward newer edges. This results in shorter walks (avg. length: 15.3) and slightly flatter distributions. The `Uniform` picker samples edges randomly without regard to time, which causes frequent walk termination and a more scattered node visitation profile (avg. length: 10.0). All three strategies retain the overall shape of the input distribution, validating that Tempest's walk sampling mechanisms preserve structural fidelity while respecting temporal causality. The choice of bias model provides fine-grained control over locality vs. exploration.

E ADDITIONAL PERFORMANCE GAP ANALYSIS

Table 2: Mean and standard deviation of the performance gap (bulk – streaming) across noise levels.

Metric	Mean Gap	Std Dev
AUC	0.0408	0.0163
Accuracy	0.0271	0.0173
Precision	0.0111	0.0246
Recall	0.0449	0.0609
F1-score	0.0355	0.0419

Figure 2 shows the downstream performance of the bulk and streaming approaches under varying levels of structured noise for

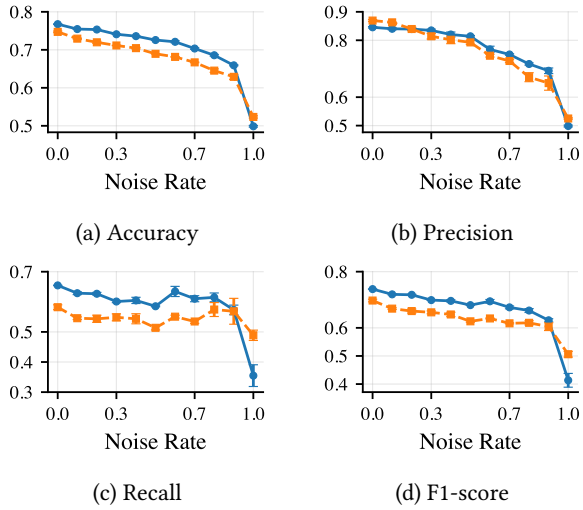


(a) `Exponential` (avg length: 96.3)

(b) `Linear` (avg length: 15.3)

(c) `Uniform` (avg length: 10.0)

Figure 1: Node visitation frequency compared to the original edge distribution on a synthetic graph.



(a) Accuracy

(b) Precision

(c) Recall

(d) F1-score

Figure 2: Downstream performance under structured noise for bulk and streaming approaches across four metrics: (a) Accuracy, (b) Precision, (c) Recall, (d) F1-score. The trends match the AUC plot in the main text.

four metrics beyond AUC: accuracy, precision, recall, and F1-score. The trends match those in the main-text AUC plot: all metrics degrade smoothly with increasing noise, and the streaming curves track the bulk curves closely with small average gaps.

Table 2 summarizes the mean and standard deviation of the gaps (bulk − streaming) for all five metrics across all tested noise levels.